Phishing Detection &Awareness Report

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a type of cyber attack in which attackers try to trick users into providing sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or personal data. These attacks are commonly performed through fake emails that appear to come from trusted organizations. This report analyzes multiple email samples to identify phishing indicators, classify risks, and provide awareness guidelines to help users avoid such attacks.

2. Methodology

The emails were analyzed based on the following criteria:

- Sender email address verification
- Link and URL inspection
- Language and tone of the message
- Presence of urgency or threats
- Email structure and greeting style

Each email was then classified as Safe, Suspicious, or Phishing based on identified indicators.

3. Email Analysis

Email 1: Bank Account Alert

Email Content:
From: security@hbl-pk-support.com
Subject: Urgent: Your HBL Account Will Be Blocked

Dear Customer,

We detected unusual activity in your account. Your account will be blocked within 24 hours unless you verify your details.

Click here to verify:
http://hbl-secure-login.xyz

Thank you,
HBL Security Team

Analysis:

- Sender domain is fake and does not match official bank domain
- Suspicious link with unknown domain (.xyz)
- Urgent language used to create panic
- Generic greeting ("Dear Customer")

Classification: Phishing

Explanation:
This email attempts to scare the user by claiming account suspension. It includes a fake link designed to steal sensitive banking information.

Email 2: Prize Scam Email

Email Content:
From: luckywinner@gmail.com
Subject: Congratulations! You Won iPhone 15

Dear User,

You have been selected as a winner of iPhone 15. Claim your prize now by clicking the link below:

http://free-iphone-claim.ru

Hurry! Offer valid for limited time.

Analysis:

- Sender uses free email service (not official)
- Suspicious and unrelated domain (.ru)
- Creates urgency and excitement
- No verification or authenticity proof

Classification: Phishing

Explanation:
This email uses a fake prize offer to trick users into clicking malicious links and possibly providing personal information.

Email 3: Job Opportunity Email

Email Content:
From: unknown123@gmail.com
Subject: Job Opportunity

Hi,

We found your profile online and have a job offer for you. Please send your CV and personal details.

Thanks

Analysis:

- Unknown sender with no company identity
- Requests personal information
- Very vague and unprofessional message
- No malicious link, but suspicious intent

Classification: Suspicious

Explanation:
This email does not contain direct phishing links but attempts to collect personal information, which can be misused.

4. Header Analysis

The email headers indicate inconsistencies between sender identity and actual sending sources. Such mismatches suggest email spoofing, a common technique used in phishing attacks to impersonate trusted organizations.

5. Risks of Phishing Attacks

Phishing attacks can result in:

- Theft of sensitive information such as passwords and banking details
- Financial loss
- Unauthorized access to personal or business accounts
- Identity theft and misuse

6. Prevention Guidelines

Users can protect themselves by following these practices:

- Always verify the sender’s email address
- Do not click on unknown or suspicious links
- Avoid downloading attachments from untrusted sources
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA)
- Use updated antivirus and security software

7. Do’s and Don’ts

Do’s:

- Carefully check email content before responding
- Report suspicious emails to the IT department
- Verify links before clicking

Don’ts:

- Do not share passwords or OTPs
- Do not click on unknown links
- Do not trust emails offering unrealistic rewards

8. Conclusion

Phishing is a serious cybersecurity threat that relies on user deception rather than system vulnerabilities. By understanding phishing indicators and following basic security practices, users can significantly reduce the risk of falling victim to such attacks. Awareness and education are key to preventing phishing incidents in organizations.